Levi Skye Morris

Engineering Leader | Staff / Principal Engineer | Payments, Data & Platform Systems
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SUMMARY

Hands-on engineering leader and former CTO with 11+ years building ledgers, payment gateways and compliant distributed systems. Led up to 20 engineers across five countries, owning hiring, coaching and performance management, while still operating as the principal engineer on a high-risk payments platform with its own ledger, KYC/AML and on-chain plus fiat settlement rails, kept at 99.9% uptime through banking loss and persistent attacks.

Core stack: TypeScript, Python, Java, Kotlin, Clojure, PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Django, NestJS, AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Terraform

EXPERIENCE

SpankChain | Remote
Chief Technology Officer / Principal Engineer | Jul 2020–Apr 2026
Acting Head of Engineering | Dec 2019–Jul 2020
Senior Software Engineer | Apr 2019–Dec 2019
High-risk payment processor for independent creators with its own ledger, KYC/AML and crypto plus fiat settlement rails.

- Architected and led the rebuild of SpankPay v2, the company's ledger and payments platform, storing an opening balance on every transaction for fast, auditable balances.
- Kept balances correct under concurrent writes with explicit locks and serializable transactions; planned hot-account splitting and migrated balances via snapshot and backfill.
- Secured digital asset custody, payments infrastructure and signing keys against persistent, well-resourced attackers, with most funds held in cold storage.
- Architected SpankPay.me, keeping independent creators paid after mainstream platforms dropped them.
- Maintained 99.9% uptime through the loss of banking partners; retained 80% of the core team through a product sunset.
- Led up to 20 engineers across five countries; mentored multiple bootcamp graduates to full productivity across the stack, from infra/platform to frontend, within a quarter of hire.

CampSpot | Denver, Colorado
Senior Software Engineer | Sep 2017–Feb 2019

- Led a three-person payments team; built a PCI DSS Level 1 payment gateway in Kotlin/Dropwizard/PostgreSQL with AES-256 encryption of cardholder data.
- Built reservation and payment systems in Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Node.js and React on AWS.

DocNetwork / CampDoc | Ann Arbor, Michigan
Development Team Lead | Aug 2015–Jun 2017

- Led a 3–5-person team building a HIPAA/FERPA-compliant EHR system on Node.js, PostgreSQL and AWS.
- Resolved severe API and PostgreSQL bottlenecks with query-plan analysis, indexing, recursive CTEs and targeted GraphQL endpoints alongside the REST API as monthly payment volume grew from six to seven figures.

SearchSpring | Colorado Springs, Colorado
Integration Specialist | Nov 2014–Aug 2015

- Built e-commerce search integrations for Shopify, Magento, NetSuite and BigCommerce, indexing catalog data into Elasticsearch.

Gelada Research Project | Simien Mountains, Ethiopia
Field Site Manager | Jun 2012–Jan 2014

- Ran a remote, high-altitude primate research station and extended its Palm Pilot data-collection software in the field.

PROJECTS

WUIXpose | 2026
Open source: Django, PostGIS, React

- Maps home ignition zones around every structure in Boulder County, served as PostGIS vector tiles to a MapLibre frontend.
- Keeps incremental jobs correct with database triggers that track geometry changes.

Computational ecology | 2026

- Ricker and stochastic eco-evolutionary models in Clojure and Python with bifurcation and Lyapunov analysis.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, Kotlin, Clojure, Python, SQL, Solidity, Vyper, R

Product and web: React, NextJS, Node.js, NestJS, Django, Express, Dropwizard, REST, GraphQL

Data: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, MongoDB

Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, EKS, Lambda, RDS, S3, KMS); GCP (GKE, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, BigQuery, Pub/Sub); Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions

AI and agentic systems: Claude Code, Codex, Qwen Code and OpenCode run in parallel with repo-level agent instructions and CI/pre-commit guardrails; LiteLLM routing to local Qwen and Gemma models

Security and cryptography: AES-256 field-level encryption, key management, digital signatures, Keycloak

Risk and compliance: PCI DSS Level 1, HIPAA, FERPA, KYC/AML, GDPR/CCPA

EDUCATION

University of Michigan | Bachelor of Science | 2012

National Science Foundation | Graduate Research Fellowship Program, Honorable Mention | 2014